

Chapter 33-1

Yin Lingzhu changed into the costume prepared by the film crew - a gray robe, with a roughly made wooden hairpin inserted in her hair, and patched shoes.

When Yin Lingzhu put it on, she couldn't help but think that the props team was really dedicated.

This story took place in ancient times. Yin Lingzhu played the second female lead, a scholar going to the capital to take the imperial examinations¹.

While sheltering from rain in a dilapidated house, she fell in love with a princess who had sneaked out, and ultimately died successfully saving the princess.

A deeply emotional second female lead with many scenes.

After reading the script, Yin Lingzhu felt that what the director had said wasn't quite right - this didn't seem like a role that required no acting skills.

After changing her clothes, Yin Lingzhu was frantically memorizing her lines when she suddenly saw Yan Si, who had also changed into costume.

Yan Si wore a goose-yellow long gown with a beige inner garment, and the fabric was even embroidered with platinum-colored thread patterns.

Yan Si's hair was pinned up from the back of her head, with silver hair ornaments interspersed throughout, and her bangs swayed as she moved.

This version of Yan Si looked like an innocent young maiden.

Yin Lingzhu silently marveled in her heart, looked away, and her appreciation for Yan Si's beauty went up another level.

Yan Si was also looking at her. Although today's Yin Lingzhu was dressed simply, her eyes were resilient, like a young person fresh out in the world², full of hope for the future.

Yan Si knew that Yin Lingzhu's natural appearance had about seventy percent similarity to this character, so this role was very suitable for her.

Yin Lingzhu felt someone watching her. She looked up and met Yan Si's gaze.

She quickly averted her eyes and focused on the script.

On the first day of filming, she and Yan Si had no scenes together - each filmed their own parts.

Today went quite smoothly. Although it was Yin Lingzhu's first time acting, the character's personality was similar to her own, so there were no major problems.

After filming for about five days, they finally reached the rain-sheltering scene, which was also the first meeting between the scholar and princess in the drama.

Yin Lingzhu was still wearing the same clothes as the first time - unchanged shoes, unchanged clothes.

But Yan Si's outfit was completely different from the first time. When she first appeared, even without speaking, one could tell from her clothing that she was of noble status.

Now Yan Si wore a simple outer robe and a matching inner garment, and the fabric also looked very ordinary.

Because Yin Lingzhu lacked experience in acting, she had memorized everything in the script that could be memorized.

The rain-sheltering scene was about the princess sneaking out, accidentally getting separated from her guards, and when it started raining heavily, she had no choice but to hide in the house.

Yin Lingzhu sighed and pulled her clothes tighter around herself, truly looking somewhat shabby.

Accompanied by the director's voice, artificial rain was sprayed from the sky. Yin Lingzhu ran through the water into the dilapidated house built by the film crew.

Then Yan Si also ran into the broken house with both hands covering her head, taking small steps.

Although the rain kept falling and the princess looked somewhat disheveled, the scholar was still moved by the princess at this moment.

"Cut!" The director's voice came through the megaphone to everyone's ears.

The rain stopped.

Yin Lingzhu saw him beckoning to her and immediately ran over.

"Director, what's wrong?" Yin Lingzhu asked.

The director glanced at the monitor, "Little Yin, your emotion is completely wrong. When the scholar sees the princess, his eyes should be filled with amazement and adoration."

"Not seeing the princess with no emotion at all."

Yin Lingzhu also looked at the monitor like the director. The herself on screen was just as the director said - her eyes showed no emotional change whatsoever.

Yin Lingzhu pressed her lips together, "Director, I might not know how to act this part."

Yin Lingzhu had prepared herself to be scolded. She also knew the director's reputation for being strict.

She closed her eyes, quietly waiting for the director's scolding.

"Little Yin, you're a newcomer. There's no need to say that." The director's eyes were full of tolerance. "What you've achieved is already beyond most people."

This was something Yin Lingzhu hadn't expected. The director didn't scold her, but was actually praising her?

Yin Lingzhu's eyes were full of excitement, "Director, don't worry. I'll definitely study hard and absolutely won't disappoint you."

The director patted her shoulder, "I believe in you. You can definitely do it."

After a morning passed, two dripping wet people appeared, but this scene still hadn't been filmed successfully.

"Achoo!" Yin Lingzhu sneezed and wrapped the bathrobe around herself tighter.

She had been unable to find the state the director wanted, so she kept getting drenched by artificial rain.

She looked in Yan Si's direction. Yan Si's condition wasn't good either - she was completely soaked.

She was wrapped in the same bathrobe as Yin Lingzhu.

Yin Lingzhu felt somewhat embarrassed. Although she didn't have much good feeling toward Yan Si now,

She and Yan Si were also colleagues, and she was wasting other people's time.

At this moment, the director came over and sat in the empty seat next to Yin Lingzhu.

"Little Yin, you've performed very well these past few days. How about this - I'll give you and Sisi³ the afternoon off to develop some chemistry for your roles."

Yan Si, who had been secretly listening to Yin Lingzhu's situation, couldn't help but give the director a thumbs up when she heard this.

She decided to invest additional funding in this drama.

Hearing the director's words, Yin Lingzhu looked toward Yan Si with difficulty. The words of refusal came to her lips but she couldn't say them.

The director had been quite good to her these past few days, and she didn't want to delay the film crew's progress.

After weighing it repeatedly, she gave the director a smile, "Alright, director, no problem."

The director nodded with satisfaction. Yan Si had already hinted to him last night - if he still didn't understand, he really shouldn't be a director.

After Yan Si confirmed that Yin Lingzhu had agreed, the little person in her heart applauded, but she didn't show it on her face, seriously wiping her wet hair with a stern expression.

The assistant stood beside her. Having followed her for many years, while others couldn't tell, she could sense it.

She looked at Yan Si, who was practically bubbling with transparent bubbles⁴, and worried about her future prospects.

Her boss had abandoned a large portion of the company's business to come here and film.

The assistant's gaze drifted to Yin Lingzhu. She knew this person, and her supervisor's recent abnormal behavior was very likely all because of this person.

After the director left, Yin Lingzhu struggled internally and was just about to get up and walk toward Yan Si when she discovered that Yan Si was actively walking toward her.

Yin Lingzhu sat in the chair, looking at Yan Si standing in front of her.

The shadow cast down, blocking the sunlight.

"Lingzhu, let's rehearse together this afternoon." Yan Si spoke somewhat urgently.

She couldn't wait for Yin Lingzhu to approach her on her own, nor did she want to wait.

Yin Lingzhu looked up at Yan Si in front of her. Her face wore a smile, but deep in her eyes was hidden anxiety.

Yin Lingzhu noticed this, "Alright."

Hearing Yin Lingzhu agree, Yan Si was somewhat excited, "Where should we rehearse? When should we start?"

A smile appeared on Yin Lingzhu's face, but not very obviously, "Let's rehearse now. The director already approved our leave, didn't he?"

"As for where to go, isn't that up to you?" Yin Lingzhu pulled out a mocking smile.

Given her and Yan Si's status relationship, whatever Yan Si told her to do, she could only do.

Hearing Yin Lingzhu say this, Yan Si didn't know where to go. After thinking in her mind for a long time, "How about going home?"

Hearing her answer, Yin Lingzhu was stunned, "Home? Where is home?"

Yan Si realized she had said the wrong thing, "I mean, that apartment in the city center."

"That apartment is quite close, and you're also familiar with it." Yan Si felt this reason wasn't enough.

"Familiar surroundings can help people relax, let the brain relax, and quickly understand knowledge."

After Yan Si finished speaking, she looked at Yin Lingzhu's eyes with some guilt.

Yin Lingzhu watched Yan Si's flustered explanation, "Didn't the director book us hotel rooms? Wouldn't the hotel be fine?"

"Why go out of our way when there's somewhere convenient?"

Yin Lingzhu's tone was light, but Yan Si sensitively felt that Yin Lingzhu's last sentence had hidden meaning.

"Fine, wherever you say we should go, that's where we'll go." Yan Si's tone carried a pleasing note.

But Yin Lingzhu unexpectedly felt somewhat uncomfortable. This version of Yan Si felt very strange and awkward to her.

The film crew had a dedicated room for rehearsing scenes, but Yin Lingzhu didn't think of it, and Yan Si didn't want to think of it.

Footnotes:

¹ Imperial examinations: The traditional Chinese civil service examination system used to select candidates for the state bureaucracy. Scholars would travel to the capital to take these prestigious exams.

² Fresh out in the world: The Chinese phrase "初出茅庐" literally means "first time leaving the thatched cottage," referring to someone young and inexperienced who is just starting their journey in life.

³ Sisi: A nickname for Yan Si, formed by repeating the "Si" part of her name, which is a common way to create affectionate nicknames in Chinese.

⁴ Bubbling with transparent bubbles: A Chinese expression used to describe someone who is obviously happy or excited but trying to hide it, like cartoon characters who have visible happiness bubbles around them.